

Ballast — 4:30 video plan

Shot-by-shot script, what to show, and how to record it. Built for the Presentation rubric (15%) and the host's hint.

Target 4:30

Hard limit 5:00

~630 spoken words

12 segments

No ideation — README covers it

The host's hint, and what it changes. Ideation (25%) is marked from the README alone. So the video spends **zero seconds** on ideas you dropped, alternatives you weighed, or your process. Every second goes to four jobs: **what it is** · **why it is novel** · **how it gets built** · **why it deserves building**. Every segment below is tagged with which job it is doing.

What each rubric line actually wants

CRITERION	WEIGHT	HOW THIS PLAN SCORES IT
Clarity of explanation	5%	One idea per segment, stated before it is demonstrated. The core claim — <code>load = time × dread</code> — is shown happening on screen in the first 45 seconds, not described.
Structure and flow	4%	Problem → idea → proof → build → why. Never doubles back. Segments 7–9 are a deliberate montage so the pace lifts before the technical section.
Delivery and confidence	4%	Short sentences, one clause each. Script is written to be <i>said</i> , not read. Three planned laugh beats stop it sounding flat.
Engagement and persuasiveness	2%	Opens on a problem the panel has personally had. Closes on the one line nothing else can say.

The shape, at a glance

HOOK 0:22	THE IDEA 0:50	PROOF — THE APP DOING IT 1:56	HOW IT IS BUILT 0:44	WHY 0:38
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Roughly 43% of the video is the product actually working. That ratio is the point — panels believe what they watch happen.

Pace check. 630 words over 270 seconds is ~140 words per minute — conversational, not rushed.
Record a timed read-through before you touch the screen recorder. If your read alone lands over 4:10, cut from the list on the last page *before* recording, not after.

The script, shot by shot

SAY is your narration. **SHOW** is the screen. *Red* marks the exact moment a click or drag has to land.

TIME	SAY	SHOW
0:00 22s WHAT	"Two weeks. Same number of hours. Same number of tasks. One of them is completely fine — the other one breaks someone. And no planner on earth can tell you which. Because every planner measures hours. And an hour of laundry is not an hour of a group presentation."	Two identical-looking week calendars side by side (a plain slide is fine — Google Calendar screenshots work). On "breaks someone" — one calendar turns red. Caption: Same hours. Very different weeks.
0:22 23s NOVEL	"So Ballast measures load as time x dread. Watch — three hours of a presentation you're dreading, six hours of reading you enjoy. Drag the dots... ...and the three-hour task overtakes the six-hour one. Half the hours. Twice the load. That one multiplication is the entire app."	<code>/welcome</code> — the intro screen. Drag the dread dots on the presentation up to 4 while you talk. The bars swap live. Let the bar movement land before you speak again. Caption: load = time x dread
0:45 27s NOVEL	"And it doesn't land in one place. Adding something takes four short pages — and on page three you don't pick a number one to five. You drag five little faces, and say what this thing takes out of your head, your hours, your body, your social life, your admin. Because a group presentation isn't 'mental'. It's mental, <i>and</i> time, <i>and</i> a social cost nobody thinks to count."	<code>/add</code> → tap Assignment → Next → Next. On page three, drag Mental up, then Time, then Social. Slowly — the faces changing expression is the moment that sells it. Caption: One task. Five areas.
1:12 18s WHAT	"Which gives you this. Forty-seven percent left — and underneath, which part of you is actually empty. Mental's at thirty-five. Physical's at eighty-three. That pairing has a fix; one number on its own doesn't. And yes, the battery has a face. It's tired too." ← laugh beat 1	<code>/</code> — Home. Hold on the battery for a full second before speaking. Point the cursor at Mental 35 and Physical 83 as you say them.
1:30 25s NOVEL	"Now the part that actually prevents something. Ballast slides a seventy-two-hour window across your next fortnight looking for density, not volume. Three deadlines over ten days is an ordinary fortnight. The same three inside seventy-two hours is a wall. And it tells you eight days out. Long enough to email a tutor or swap a shift."	<code>/plan</code> — the 14-day strip. On "wall", the collision card is already on screen — hover it. Caption: Warned 8 days early

1:55 33s NOVEL	"Then it prices what you could put down. Toggle — and the battery moves live. Notice the group presentation. You can't toggle it. Hard deadlines are locked, because an app that suggests skipping your exam is an app you stop trusting. And then the twist. Knowing what to cut was never the hard part — writing the message is. Four days of drafting a text in your Notes app; we've all done it. ← laugh beat 2 So Ballast writes it. Three tones. It never sends anything."	/rebalance — toggle two trades, let the % climb. Then try to tap the locked Group presentation row so the panel sees it refuse. Then /decline/w11-birthday — switch tone Warm → Fully honest so the message visibly rewrites.
2:28 22s WHAT	"Assignments stop hiding until the night before. Work you owe sits on every single day until it's done — and this button reads your real week and books your study sittings across your lightest days. It even tells you the hours it can't fit, instead of letting you find that out on Wednesday night."	Home, scrolled to the Owing band. Press "Book 3 sittings for me" and let the preview appear. Do not rush this — it is your strongest single feature.
2:50 22s WHAT	"Your evening gets planned around what you actually do — add badminton, it becomes a permanent slider. And when you've got twelve things and no idea where to start: one ranked list. Deadline, who you promised, how much is left, and whether it can even still be finished."	Fast cuts, ~10s each. /actions → drag one slider, battery moves. /priority → scroll the ranked rows so the reason chips read.
3:12 14s NOVEL	"You can also see which friends actually have room before you ask — a band, never a number — and it finds the one evening that works for all of you."	/areas/social — hold on the row of friends with their batteries (62%, 24%, 8%, 71%).
3:26 32s HOW	"It's Expo and React Native — one codebase for iOS, Android and web. It's live right now: no install, no sign-in, open it on your phone. Everything runs on the device. No server, no network. The scheduler is a real algorithm, not a language model — which is why it still works on a bus with no signal. And none of this is a mock-up. Three hundred and thirteen automated checks prove every button moves the state it claims to."	Cut away from the phone. 1 — the live URL typed into a browser. 2 — the architecture diagram from README §5.2. 3 — a terminal running npm run preflight, green. Screen-record this beforehand and speed it up 4x.
3:58 12s HOW	"If we go ahead, three weeks adds accounts and sync. That's genuinely the only thing the app can't already do on its own."	The three-week table from README §5.3, one row highlighting at a time.
4:10 20s WHY	"Every wellbeing app tells a drowning student to breathe. Ballast tells them which three things to put down — and writes the awkward message for	Back to Home. The battery, the face. Final frame: logo + live URL, held for 3 seconds in silence.

them.

Caption: **load-balancer-ballast.expo.app**

No streaks. No scores. Nothing says 'supportive' like
an app shaming you for missing a day in exam week.

← laugh beat 3

Ballast. The weight you carry on purpose, so you
don't capsize."

Recording it

Getting a clean phone recording

- **Best:** open the live URL on a real phone, screen-record, then drop it into a phone frame in editing. Most convincing — it is obviously a phone.
- **Easiest:** desktop Chrome → DevTools → device toolbar → **iPhone 14 Pro**. Record that region only.
- Hide the URL bar and bookmarks. A visible browser chrome makes it read as a website, not an app.
- Move the cursor **slowly and deliberately**. Fast cursors read as nervous.

Before you hit record

- Open **Areas** → **Reset to the seeded week**. Every number in this script assumes the seeded state.
- Check the app reads **47%** on Home. If it doesn't, you reset wrong.
- Turn off notifications. One Slack banner costs you a retake.
- Record narration **separately** from the screen. Trying to talk and demo at once is why most submissions sound hesitant.

Captions — do not skip these

Assume a panel watches at least part of it **muted**. Burn in captions (CapCut, Premiere or YouTube auto-captions corrected by hand). Beyond the full subtitles, put these **seven** phrases on screen as large text at the moment you say them — they are the takeaways you want remembered:

TIME	ON-SCREEN TEXT	WHY THIS ONE
0:14	Same hours. Very different weeks.	The problem, in four words.
0:30	load = time x dread	The single thing you want them to remember.
0:58	One task. Five areas.	Your biggest departure from every competitor.
1:44	Warned 8 days early	Proves it prevents rather than reports.
2:10	Hard deadlines are locked	Signals judgement, not just features.
3:45	313 automated checks	The line that separates you from a Figma mock-up.
4:27	load-balancer-ballast.expo.app	Hold 3 seconds. Let them write it down.

Delivery

- **Smile on the first line.** It is audible, and it buys you the whole first segment.
- **Land the three jokes and then move on.** Do not pause for a laugh that isn't in the room.
- **Slow down on numbers.** "Forty-seven percent." "Eight days out." "Three hundred and thirteen."
- **Full stop = full stop.** Short sentences are already written in; just honour them.
- **Never say "um, so basically".** Re-record the line instead — it costs eight seconds.
- **Last line: slower and quieter.** Confidence at the end reads as conviction.

If you are over 4:50 — cut in this order

1. **Friends (3:12, -14s)** — the only segment nothing else depends on.
2. **"And yes, the battery has a face. It's tired too." (-5s)** — lovely, not load-bearing.
3. **The Notes-app joke (-7s)** — keep "writing the message is" and drop the aside.
4. **Tonight, down to one sentence (-10s)** — keep Priority; it is the stronger of the pair.

Never cut: the hook, the dread drag at 0:22, the five dials, or "313 automated checks". Those four carry Clarity, Novelty and Feasibility between them.

Five ways teams lose Presentation marks

1. **Running over.** The limit is stated in the rubric; 5:01 is a scored penalty. Export, watch, check the runtime.
2. **Explaining the ideation.** The README is marked for that. In the video it is 60 seconds you cannot afford.
3. **Narrating the UI.** "Now I click here, and this opens..." Say what it *means*; let the screen show the click.
4. **A slide deck with no product.** You have a live app. Nearly half this video is it working — that is your advantage, use it.
5. **Trailing off.** End on the closing line and a held logo. No "...so, yeah, thanks."